Jay-Z Will Finally Sing at the Super Bowl Halftime Show

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Rapper Jay-Z will sing at the Super Bowl **halftime** show in February, the NFL has announced. It will be his first time singing at the big game, even though his company, **Roc Nation**, has made the **halftime** show since 2019 and he has helped pick each year's singer.

Super Bowl LXI will take place on February 14 near Los Angeles. Jay-Z will follow recent **halftime** stars like Bad Bunny, Kendrick Lamar, Usher, Rihanna and The Weeknd.

The news came after Jay-Z, whose real name is Shawn Carter, sang two shows last weekend at the Los Angeles stadium where the Super Bowl will be played. They were part of a tour celebrating 30 years since his first album, Reasonable Doubt.

Jay-Z called the journey from Reasonable Doubt to the Super Bowl stage a dream come true. Roger Goodell, the NFL **commissioner**, said he could not be more excited for fans to enjoy Jay-Z's **artistry** and **cultural impact**. He added that his one request when the NFL first worked with **Roc Nation** was for Jay-Z to sing on stage himself one day.

Word Treasure

halftime -- The break in the middle of a game.
commissioner -- The person in charge of a sports league.
artistry -- Skill and creativity in making music or art.
cultural impact -- The way a person's work changes what people enjoy and talk about.
Roc Nation -- Jay-Z's company that has helped make the halftime show.

Background you need

The Super Bowl is a big football championship game, and its halftime show is a famous music performance in the middle of the game.

Jay-Z is a rapper whose company has helped make the halftime show and pick its singers.

This will be his first time singing at the big game himself.

Break it down

WHO: Jay-Z, whose real name is Shawn Carter, a rapper whose company Roc Nation has helped make the halftime show.

WHAT: Jay-Z will sing at the Super Bowl halftime show for the first time.

WHERE: At the Super Bowl near Los Angeles, in the stadium where he recently sang two shows.

WHY: Because Roger Goodell had asked, when the NFL first worked with Roc Nation, for Jay-Z to sing on stage himself one day.

Why it matters

It shows how working toward a dream can lead to a big moment you once only hoped for.

Test what you remember

1. What will Jay-Z do at the Super Bowl halftime show in February?

- (A) Announce the halftime singer
- (B) Sing at the halftime show
- (C) Coach a football team
- (D) Play in the game

2. Has Jay-Z sung at the Super Bowl halftime show before?

- (A) No, it will be his first time singing at the big game
- (B) Yes, with Roc Nation
- (C) Yes, many times
- (D) No, he has never watched the game

3. Where will Super Bowl LXI take place?

- (A) In London
- (B) Near New York
- (C) In Las Vegas
- (D) Near Los Angeles

4. Who said he could not be more excited for fans to enjoy Jay-Z's artistry and cultural impact?

- (A) Usher
- (B) Shawn Carter
- (C) Bad Bunny
- (D) Roger Goodell

5. What was Roger Goodell's one request when the NFL first worked with Roc Nation?

- (A) That Jay-Z pick each year's singer
- (B) That Jay-Z sing on stage himself one day
- (C) That the show move to Los Angeles
- (D) That Jay-Z make a new album

6. Where did Jay-Z recently sing two shows?

- (A) On a tour bus
- (B) At a stadium in New York
- (C) At the Los Angeles stadium where the Super Bowl will be played
- (D) At the NFL offices

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: D 4: D 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Jay-Z: He called the journey from Reasonable Doubt to the Super Bowl stage a dream come true.

2. Roger Goodell: He said he could not be more excited for fans to enjoy Jay-Z's artistry and cultural impact.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):